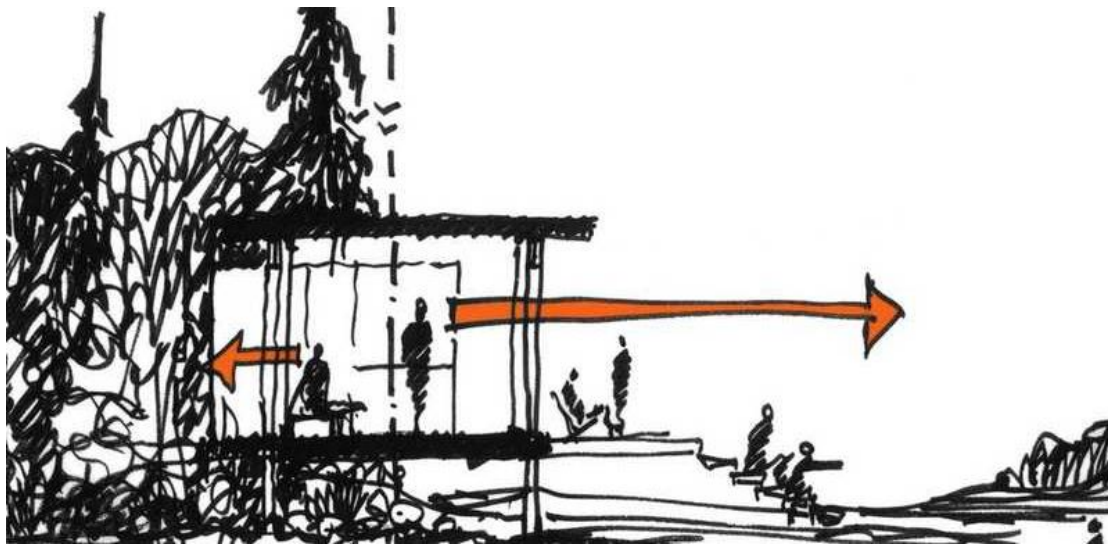


DI 1016 Introduction to Ecology and Landscape Design-2025-Assignment 02

1.0 This focuses on application of one of the main Ecological theories (PROSPECT AND REFUGE) to experience landscape and prepare a report/ journal explaining students' own experience in selected context.

Prospect and Refuge Theory, introduced by British geographer Jay Appleton in 1975, is a foundational concept in landscape architecture and environmental psychology. It posits that humans prefer landscapes that provide both **prospect** (an open, panoramic view to survey the surroundings) and **refuge** (a safe, enclosed, or sheltered spot to hide)



The theory in landscape architecture further explains why people prefer spaces offering both prospect (clear views) and refuge (safety) for survival, applying evolutionary psychology to design inviting environments with balanced vistas and protected niches, like window seats or gazebos, creating comfort through a sense of being able to see danger (predators/threats) while remaining hidden, a concept applicable to gardens, parks, and urban spaces to enhance user experience and perceived safety.

Key Applications in Landscape Design

- **Creating Comfortable Vantage Points:** Placing benches or seating areas at the edge of open lawns or overlooking water features provides prospect (view) with refuge (nearby trees, walls) for security.
- **Layering Spaces:** Using dense shrubbery (refuge) with gaps to reveal broader vistas (prospect) creates dynamic, engaging spaces.
- **Design for Safety in Public Spaces:** Adding alcoves, window displays, or street furniture in urban settings offers partial concealment, making areas feel less exposed and more inviting.

- **Incorporating Natural Features:** Trees providing shade, caves, overhangs, or dense woodlands act as natural refuges, while clearings offer prospect.
- **Biophilic Design Integration:** The theory supports biophilic principles by connecting people to natural patterns of observation and safety, enhancing well-being.

2.0 Given contexts for the observation, study and record.

- a. University of Moratuwa, Bolgoda water edge.
 - b. Thalangama wewa and surrounding.
 - c. Any outdoor gathering area in the University of Moratuwa.
 - d. Mountain landscape in central hill in Sri Lanka.
- You can select only one for your study and record.

3.0 Tentative content of the report

1. Introduction
2. Explain the location of your study context
3. Explain your experience by using photographs / sketches with identifying prospects and refuge places. Incorporating above given key application in landscape design.
4. Conclusion.
5. References and readings.

4.0 References

Appleton, J. (1975). *The Experience of Landscape*. London: Wiley.

Appleton, J. (1984). "Prospects and refuges re-visited". *Landscape Journal* 3(2): 91–103.

Beatley, T. (2016). *Handbook of Biophilic City Planning & Design*. Island Press.

Chertow, M. R. (2000). "Industrial Symbiosis: Literature and Taxonomy." *Annual Review of Energy and the Environment*,

Hildebrand, G. (1991). *The Wright Space: Pattern and Meaning in Frank Lloyd Wright's Houses*. Seattle: University of Washington Press.

Hildebrand, G. (1999). *Origins of Architectural Pleasure*. Berkeley: University of California Press

Van der Ryn, Sim and Stuart Cowan (2007). *Ecological Design, Tenth Anniversary Edition*. Washington, DC:

Van der Ryn, Sim (2013). *Design for an Empathic World: Reconnecting People, Nature, and Self* 2nd None ed. Edition.

5.0 Submission:

1000 words and better to limit 4 A4 pages including diagrams. Individual submission. The submission deadline is **14th of February 2026**.

6.0 Evaluation: Assignment 02- 50% of total

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